

# Karim Valiev

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🇬🇧 UK Global Talent visa holder, based in 🇧🇪 Tbilisi, Georgia · Moving to London

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## Summary

Cybersecurity leader and software engineer building AI-agent products. Deep expertise in Python, Linux, networking and databases. Built an autonomous AI pentesting platform. Established a security program at an internet company with 100+ products. Experienced in hiring and mentoring engineers while staying close to the code.

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## Experience

### Co-founder & CTO, Autonomous AI Pentesting Platform (2025–present)

- Built an end-to-end platform turning company scope into verified, client-ready pentest reports
- Implemented large-scale deterministic scanning, parallel AI agent execution and evidence verification; evaluated on XBOW, Vulhub and custom benchmarks
- Built an automated development pipeline: specs → Linear → Codex/Claude → tests → GitHub PRs
- Delivered pilots that uncovered critical vulnerabilities and closed three client sales with my co-founder

### Founder & Developer, Attack Surface Management Tool (2022–2025)

- Built an attack surface management platform with a Python scheduler and custom & OSS modules, continuously monitoring 100k+ hosts
- Optimized scanning throughput and resource utilization with adaptive scheduling and congestion/packet-loss controls
- One-click cloud and bare-metal deployment (Ansible, Docker, GitHub Actions); React dashboard and Telegram alerts; automated tests and performance profiling

### CISO, VK / Mail.Ru (2017–2021)

- Built a company-wide security program for 100+ products; scaled the team 7 → 50, established per-product security units and launched a 24×7 SOC + IR center
- Hardened infrastructure: per-service firewalls, YubiKey-based SSH/VPN, certificate-based Wi-Fi and automated vulnerability scanning
- Built and ran a [top-7](#) global HackerOne bug-bounty program by total payouts (2020) and an ongoing third-party red-team program
- Led incident response and crisis communications; drove M&A security

### Security Team Lead, VK / Mail.Ru (2014–2017)

### Security Analyst, VK / Mail.Ru (2013–2014)

### Software Developer, Stream.Ru (2012–2013)

## Core Skills

- **Dev:** Python, Go, C/C++, LLM agent systems (LangGraph), Linux kernel & eBPF, Docker/K8s, KVM/QEMU, CI/CD (Ansible, GitHub Actions), MySQL, Elasticsearch, AWS & GCP
  - **Networking:** TCP/IP (L2–L4), Firewalls, datacenter & office networks, VLANs, Scapy
  - **Security:** Pentesting & Bug Bounty, Incident Response / SOC, Vulnerability Management & Code Audits, PKI & Cryptography
  - **Mobile / IoT:** Android internals (NDK, Magisk, Frida), OpenWrt porting (previously unsupported router), ESP8266/ESP32, Bluetooth & Zigbee, Home Assistant & ESPHome
  - **AI-augmented:** Binary reverse engineering, Linux kernel debugging, frontend development
  - **Leadership:** 7 yrs tech management — hiring, mentoring, project & security program delivery
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## Community & Recognition

- **Open-source:**  
<https://github.com/valievkarim/spinrun> - tool to boot a clean, disposable Alpine Linux VM using QEMU in < 0.7s  
  
Bugfixes to public projects: Ansible community.general (2025, included in Ansible), Nuclei scanner (2023), SQLAlchemy (2022), html5lib (2013), MediaInfo (2013)
  - **Vulnerability research:**  
Featured in Halls of Fame from [Google](#), [Yandex](#), [Mozilla](#), Microsoft, [Alibaba](#) and [Salesforce](#) (2015–2021)
  - **CTF:**  
Founded VK team – ranked #7 in Russia (2020–2021)  
Former core player, MSU “Bushwhackers” – multiple #1 RU/international wins (2010–2015)
  - **Public speaking:**
    - Launch is Tomorrow podcast – [modern auth](#) (2024), [security at scale](#) (2019)
    - Conference talks and panels on [applied cryptography](#), [scanner benchmarking](#) and [cybersecurity careers](#) (2012–2021)
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## Education

M.Sc. Mathematics & Computer Science, Moscow State University (2008–2013)